

The True Cost of Ownership

You may be tempted by the looks of certain cars or trucks, or the affordable price of a particular model, but there's more to consider than appearances and cost when buying a new car. What's the repair record of this make and model? Are there problems with certain components of the car, such as the brakes or the transmission? What does it cost for routine repairs and maintenance? What kind of mileage does it get? What does it cost to insure? How is its safety record?

You can buy a new car for \$10,000, but if it's not well made or doesn't have a good repair record, you are likely to end up pumping money into repairs. If, on the other hand, you buy a more expensive car with a good repair record, you may save money over the life of the car. *Consumer Reports* does extensive research on the repair records of many makes and models, so do your homework before you buy.



ESSENTIAL

Even the color of your car can affect your insurance rates. For instance, red sports cars cost more to insure because insurance companies assume drivers of red sports cars will drive at excessive speeds and therefore get in more accidents.
